Week 14: The Books of Solomon

How to Read the Bible — 19-Week Study

Three books in the Bible are tied to King Solomon — tonight we'll look at Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and Song of Songs, and how they relate to his story.

1. Who's the wisest person you personally know — not just smart, but wise? What makes them different from someone who's simply intelligent?

2. **Read Proverbs 1.** Where does Wisdom go to call out, and what does she say will happen to those who ignore her? What does it mean to you that wisdom is portrayed as actively pursuing us, rather than something we only find if we go looking hard enough?

3. Proverbs 1 also warns against being lured in by people who promise easy gain through shortcuts and violence. What's the modern version of that kind of enticement — the voice that says the fast, self-serving path is smarter than the patient, honest one?

4. It's striking that Proverbs — a book urging faithfulness to wisdom — is attributed to Solomon, the very king whose story ends in failure. Why do you think the Bible would put warnings about wisdom in the mouth of someone who didn't ultimately live them out?

5. **Read Ecclesiastes 12.** What images does the poem use to describe old age and death, and what's the final instruction the book lands on? Why do you think Ecclesiastes insists on being this blunt about mortality instead of ending on a more comfortable note?

6. Ecclesiastes repeats that life "under the sun" is fleeting and often unfair — hevel, or vapor. How do you personally hold on to faith and purpose when so much of life feels outside your control?

7. **Read Song of Songs 4.** What does the lover say he finds beautiful about his beloved, and how does she answer his pursuit? This is unabashedly romantic, even sensual, poetry — and the Bible devotes a whole book to it. Why do you think it's

here? What does it say that Scripture treats human desire and delight as worth a book of their own?

8. Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and Song of Songs each offer a different lens on "the good life" — one confident that wisdom leads to blessing, one honest about how unpredictable life actually is, and one celebrating desire and pleasure. Why might the Bible want to hold all three perspectives together instead of settling on just one?

9. Every day, in ways big and small, we choose between being "wise in our own eyes" and trusting God's wisdom instead. Where is that choice most real for you right now?